MILITARY STANDARD

ABBREVIATIONS (FOR ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONIC USE)

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DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
DEFENSE SUPPLY MANAGEMENT AGENCY
OFFICE OF STANDARDIZATION
WASHINGTON 25, D. C.

18 MAY 1953

Abbreviations
(for Electrical and Electronic Use)
MIL–STD–103

1. This standard has been approved by the Defense Supply Management Agency for use by the Departments of the Army, the Navy, and the Air Force.

2. In accordance with established procedure the Office of Standardization has designated the Signal Corps, Bureau of Ships, and the Air Force respectively, as Army-Navy-Air Force custodians of this standard.

3. This standard is mandatory for use effective 18 May 1953 by the Departments of the Army, the Navy, and the Air Force.

4. Recommended corrections, additions, or deletions should be addressed to the Chief, Office of Standardization, Defense Supply Management Agency, Washington 25, D. C.

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1. GENERAL

1.1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1.1 *Purpose.*—The purpose of this standard is to establish an approved list of abbreviations for terms commonly used in the electrical and electronic field.

1.1.2 *Scope.*—This standard covers those abbreviations not presently covered in MIL–STD–12, Abbreviations for Use on Drawings. It is intended that the abbreviations in this standard plus the abbreviations for electrical and electronic terms appearing in MIL–STD–12 be used in text and on drawings.

1.1.3 *Application.*—The use of abbreviations is not mandatory but is left to the discretion of the agency concerned. However, where abbreviations are used, they shall conform to this standard.

1.2 FORM

1.2.1 *Short words.* — Short words are omitted, except where their abbreviations have been established by long-standing practice.

1.2.2 *Spacing.*—Spaces between letters of an abbreviation are used solely for clarity. The use of hyphens and slant bars is avoided where practicable.

1.2.3 *Use of periods.*—Periods are used only to avoid misinterpretation of an abbreviation.

1.2.4 *Lettering.*—Upper-case or lower-case letters may be used as appropriate except where the use of a particular case has been established by long-standing practice.

1.3 RULES FOR USE

1.3.1 *Clarity.*—Abbreviations shall be used only when their meanings are unquestionably clear. WHEN IN DOUBT, SPELL IT OUT.

1.3.2 *Text.*—Wherever practicable, the first time an abbreviation is used in text, it will be inclosed in parentheses and preceded by the word or term it represents written in full.

1.3.3 *Word combinations.*—Abbreviations of word combinations shall be used as such and shall not be separated for use singly. Combination of single abbreviations is authorized as required.

1.3.4 *Tense and number.*—The same abbreviation shall be used for all tenses, and the singular and plural forms of a given word.

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2. ALPHABETICAL LIST OF TERMS

Term	Abbreviation	
Air-position indicator	API	api
Ampere (combining form)	A	a
Ampere-hour	AH	ah
Anti-transmit-receive	ATR	atr
Automatic direction finder	ADF	adf
Automatic phase control	APC	apc
Band display	BNDDIS	bnddis
Band elimination	BE	be
Band pass	BP	bp
Bel (combining form)	B	b
Brilliance	BRIL	bril
Broadcast	BC	bc
Centi (10^{-2})	C	c
Challenge	CHAL	chal
Continuous Commercial Service	CCS	ccs
Crystal oscillator	CO	co
Crystal unit (piezoelectric)	CU	cu
Cutoff	CO	co
Cycle (combining form)	C	c
Deci (10^{-1})	D	d
Decibels above reference noise	DBRN	dbrn
Decibel referred to 1 volt	DBV	dbv
Decibel referred to 1 watt	DBW	dbw
Decrease	DECR	decr
Distance-measuring equipment	DME	dme
Double sideband	DSB	dsb
Equivalent noise-sideband input	ENSI	ensi
Extremely high frequency	EHF	ehf
Facsimile	FAX	fax
Foot-lambert	FL	fl
Frequency-shift keying	FSK	fsk
Ground-controlled approach	GCA	gca
Ground-controlled interception	GCI	gci
Ground position indicator	GPI	gpi
High pass	HP	hp
Identification friend or foe	IFF	iff
Identification of position	IP	ip
Inductance-capacitance-resistance	LCR	lcr
Instrument landing system	ILS	ils
Intermittent commercial and amateur service	ICAS	icas
Interrogator-responder	IR	ir
Low-altitude bombing	LAB	lab
Lowest usable high frequency	LUHF	luhf
Low pass	LP	lp
Maximum usable frequency	MUF	muf
Medium frequency	MF	mf
Mega (10^6)	MEG	meg
Moving-target indicator	MTI	mti
Multiplex	MX	mx
Multivibrator	MVB	mvb
Optimum working frequency	OWF	owf
Override	OVRD	ovrd
Peak to peak	PP	pp
Phase modulation	PM	pm
Phonograph	PHONO	phono
Photoelectric scanner	PES	pes
Piezoelectric-crystal unit	CU	cu
Power-line carrier	PLC	plc
Power oscillator	PO	po
Preamplifier	PREAMP	preamp
Precision approach radar	PAR	par
Pulse-amplitude modulation	PAM	pam
Pulse-code modulation	PCM	pcm
Pulse-count modulation	PCTM	pctm
Pulse-duration modulation	PDM	pdm
Pulse per second	PPS	pps
Pulse-position modulation	PPM	ppm
Pulse repetition rate	PRR	prr
Pulse-time modulation	PTM	ptm
Pulse-width modulation	PWM	pwm
Range marks	RM	rm
Resolver	RSVR	rsvr
Root-sum-square	RSS	rss
Saturable reactor	SR	sr
Second (combining form)	S	s
Short time constant	STC	stc
Signal-to-noise ratio	SNR	snr
Single sideband	SSB	ssb
Single signal	SS	ss
Super-high frequency	SHF	shf
Synchronizing	SYN	syn
Teleprinter	TPR	tpr
Terrain-clearance indicator	TCI	tci
Transverse electric	TE	te
Transverse electromagnetic	TEM	tem
Transverse magnetic	TM	tm
Traveling wave	TW	tw
Very-high frequency omnidirectional radio range	VOR	vor
Vestigial sideband	VSB	vsb
Video	VID	vid
Visual-aural radio range	VAR	var
Voice frequency	VF	vf
Volt ampere, reactive	VAR	var
Volt per meter	VPM	vpm

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ALPHABETICAL LIST OF TERMS

Abbreviation	*Term*
A	a—ampere (combining form)
ADF	adf—automatic direction finder
AH	ah—ampere-hour
APC	apc—automatic phase control
API	api—air-position indicator
ATR	atr—anti-transmit-receive
B	b—bel (combining form)
BC	bc—broadcast
BE	be—band elimination
BNDDIS	bnddis—band display
BP	bp—band pass
BRIL	bril—brilliance
C	c—centi (10^{-2}), cycle (combining form)
CCS	ccs—continuous commercial service
CHAL	chal—challenge
CO	co—crystal oscillator
CO	co—cutoff
CU	cu—piezoelectric-crystal unit
D	d—deci (10^{-1})
DBRN	dbrn—decibels above reference noise
DBV	dbv—decibel referred to 1 volt
DBW	dbw—decibel referred to 1 watt
DECR	decr—decrease
DME	dme—distance-measuring equipment
DSB	dsb—double sideband
EHF	ehf—extremely high frequency
ENSI	ensi—equivalent-noise-sideband input
FAX	fax—facsimile
FL	fl—foot-lambert
FSK	fsk—frequency-shift keying
GCA	gca—ground-controlled approach
GCI	gci—ground-controlled interception
GPI	gpi—ground position indicator
HP	hp—high pass
ICAS	icas—intermittent commercial and amateur service
IFF	iff—identification friend or foe
ILS	ils—instrument landing system
IP	ip—identification of position
IR	ir—interrogator-responder
LAB	lab—low-altitude bombing
LCR	lcr—inductance-capacitance-resistance
LP	lp—low pass
LUHF	luhf—lowest usable high frequency
MEG	meg—mega (10^{6})
MF	mf—medium frequency
MTI	mti—moving-target indicator
MUF	muf—maximum usable frequency
MVB	mvb—multivibrator
MX	mx—multiplex
OVRD	ovrd—override
OWF	owf—optimum working frequency
PAM	pam—pulse-amplitude modulation
PAR	par—precision approach radar
PCM	pcm—pulse-code modulation
PCTM	pctm—pulse-count modulation
PDM	pdm—pulse-duration modulation
PES	pes—photoelectric scanner
PHONO	phono—phonograph
PLC	plc—power-line carrier
PM	pm—phase modulation
PO	po—power oscillator
PP	pp—peak to peak
PPM	ppm—pulse position modulation
PPS	pps—pulse per second
PREAMP	preamp—preamplifier
PRR	prr—pulse-repetition rate
PTM	ptm—pulse-time modulation
PWM	pwm—pulse-width modulation
RM	rm—range marks
RSS	rss—root-sum-square
RSVR	rsvr—resolver
S	s—second (combining form)
SHF	shf—super-high frequency
SNR	snr—signal-to-noise ratio
SR	sr—saturable reactor
SS	ss—single signal
SSB	ssb—single sideband
STC	stc—short time constant
SYN	syn—synchronizing
TCI	tci—terrain-clearance indicator
TE	te—transverse electric
TEM	tem—transverse electromagnetic
TM	tm—transverse magnetic
TPR	tpr—teleprinter
TW	tw—traveling wave
VAR	var—visual-aural radio range; volt-ampere, reactive
VF	vf—voice frequency
VID	vid—video
VOR	vor—very-high frequency omnidirectional radio range
VPM	vpm—volt per meter
VSB	vsb—vestigial sideband

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